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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

INDIAN AND PAKISTANI FANS UNITE TO CELEBRATE CRICKET

Indian and Pakistani fans show their support during the India-Pakistan match in the Asia Cup at Dubai International Cricket Stadium yesterday. Dubai witnessed a sea of blue and green as fans of both sides turned up in full force. Pakistan, batting first after winning the toss, scored 127/9 in 20 overs.

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Qatar to world: Stop using double standards

DOHA HOSTS SUMMIT AMID CALLS FOR STRONG RESPONSE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Qatari Prime Minister Shaikh Mohammad Bin Abdulrahman Al Thani yesterday urged the international community to "stop using double standards" and punish Israel for what he described as its "crimes".

He was speaking at a preparatory meeting on the eve of an emergency summit of Arab and Islamic leaders organised by Qatar after Israel carried out an unprecedented air strike on Hamas leaders in Doha.

Calls to punish Israel

"The time has come for the international community to stop using double standards and to punish Israel for all the crimes it has committed, and Israel needs to know that the ongoing war of extermination that our brotherly Palestinian people is being subjected to, and whose aim is to expel them from their land, will not work," the Prime Minister said.

He said that the meeting condemned Israel's "barbaric" at-

The meeting condemned Israel's 'barbaric' attack and backed Qatar's right to protect its sovereignty, calling for strong, decisive measures in response to the assault.

tack and backed Qatar's right to protect its sovereignty, calling for strong, decisive measures in response to the assault.

The meeting stressed that Israel's genocidal campaign to displace Palestinians will not succeed. It warned that that Israel's rejection of peace proposals is dangerously widening the conflict across the region.

Qatar is hosting an emergency Arab-Islamic summit today in response to the Israeli strike.

Earlier, Majed Bin Mohammad Al Ansari, spokesman for Qatar's Foreign Ministry, told the state news agency QNA that the timing of the summit underscores "broad Arab and Islamic solidarity with the State of Qatar."

On Tuesday, Israel targeted a residential compound in Doha

housing senior Hamas officials, killing five Hamas members and a Qatari security guard.

Jamal Rushdi, spokesperson for the Arab League's secretary-general, said the summit aims to send a strong message of solidarity with Qatar and highlight that mediators should not be attacked under international law.

Several local and regional media reports have suggested that a new Arab and Islamic cooperation framework might be on the agenda.

The summit also comes as Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu continues to threaten various Arab and Middle Eastern capitals with more strikes, saying the attack on Doha may only be the beginning of a wider campaign targeting Hamas leaders abroad.

It also comes two days after the UN Security Council on Thursday condemned the strikes on Qatar and called for de-escalation.

Meanwhile, Netanyahu said that the alliance with the United States has never been stronger as he joined Secretary of State Marco Rubio in praying at one of Judaism's holiest sites.

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